



AI SEO Mastery Pro [Start ...

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Getting Started



SEO Foundation



Setting Up Your AI



Local SEO Foundations



How to Do Local AI SEO



The Google Business Pr...



Creating AI Content



Building a Core 30 Web...



Starting Off-Site AI SEO



Introduction to Backlinking

External Anchor Text Guideli...

Local Authority Building

Searching for Link Opportun...

Monthly Google News Featu...

Blog Commenting



Optimizing for AI Syste...



How ChatGPT Makes Reco...

Introduction to Backlinking



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6-min ⚡ 5 min 7 sec

Backlinks are the foundation of Google's search algorithm and remain one of the most powerful ranking factors in SEO. In this lesson, we'll explore what backlinks are, why they matter, and how they influence your website's ability to rank in search results.

What Are Backlinks?

A backlink is simply a link from one website to another. When website A links to website B, that's a backlink for website B. Think of backlinks as votes of confidence from other websites—they signal to Google that your content is valuable and trustworthy enough for others to reference.

Alphabet (Google's parent company) became a trillion-dollar company largely because of their revolutionary approach to

algorithm.

The Problem Backlinks Solved

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Data Source: ChatGPT VS. G...

How to Check Business Visi...

Proving Business Legitimacy

High Quality Mentions

Create Even More Schema

Review Diversification and S...

Reddit Optimization

Special Circumstances

YMYL-Niche Sites

Ethics: E-E-A-T Authorship ...

When to Use a Sitemap

NoFollow Attributes on Links

Hiding Content from Users

Disavowing Existing Backlin...

Non-Local SEO

Non-Local SEO Engagement...

Basic Site Structure

Search Console for Existing ...

Click Through Rate (CTR) A...

Before Google, search engines struggled with a fundamental question: **How do we determine if a website is trustworthy?**

- **Yahoo** manually reviewed websites and created curated lists (time-consuming and limited)
- **AltaVista** had no effective trust system (poor results)
- **Google** used backlinks as automated trust signals (scalable and effective)

How Backlinks Influence Rankings

Backlinks represent approximately **50% of your ranking position**, based on correlation studies with Ahrefs' backlink data. Here's how they work in different scenarios:

When your site ranks **below the first page**, Google relies heavily on:

- Backlink quantity and quality
- On-page content optimization
- Overall site authority (multiplying factor)

Once you reach the first page, Google shifts focus to user engagement metrics:

- Click-through rates
- Time on site
- Goal completions
- User experience signals

💡 **Did You Know?** Google built Chrome and Android partly to collect user experience data. For example, if



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Generate topical relevance

Keyword Research Philosop...

AI-Generate Keyword Variati...

TL;DR - Always answer your phone—it's good for rankings AND lead generation!

Creating a Content Planner

AI-Rewriting Pages

Key Backlink Principles

Quality Over Quantity

A few high-quality, trustworthy backlinks are far more valuable than many low-quality links. Focus on earning links from:

- Relevant local organizations
- Industry authorities
- Trusted websites in your niche

▶▶ **Related Lesson:** [Searching for Link Opportunities](#)

Domain Diversity Matters

Multiple links from the same website have diminishing returns. Instead of sponsoring the same softball team every year, diversify your link sources by supporting different organizations with different websites.

One Link Per Article

When building content for relevance, you typically only need **one backlink per article** to:

- Get the content crawled and indexed
- Signal trust to Google
- Pass authority to your page

Understanding PBNs (Private Blog Networks)

A PBN is a network of websites owned and controlled by the same entity but disguised to appear independent to Google.



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⚠ If Google discovers a PBN:

- The entire network may be de-indexed
- You'll lose the ranking benefits from those links

- Your site returns to where it would rank without the PBN links
- Your main site typically isn't penalized—you just lose the artificial boost

⚠ **Recommendation:** Building your own PBN is complex and risky. For most local businesses, focusing on legitimate local link-building strategies is more sustainable.

An estimated **80% of websites** exist primarily to provide link authority to the 20% that generate actual traffic. This massive ecosystem demonstrates just how crucial backlinks remain for SEO success.